

VibeHaus — Product Scope, Backlog & Roadmap

Tagline: Your vibe. Your people. Your city. **Primary audience:** expats/newcomers in Berlin, open to locals. **Navigation:** Discover · Events · My Haus (Vibemates · Chats) · Profile. A **Calendar** (header icon, every tab) surfaces upcoming/pending Coffee/Activity Vibes and Events in one place. **Consent principle:** increasing intimacy requires increasing consent. **Platform note:** launching as a mobile-first responsive web app (built in Lovable) — not a native iOS/Android app. Native apps are a separate, later undertaking (Epic J2).

.

1. Core Product Flow (MVP hypothesis)

Can fit-first, explained recommendations combined with mutual intent help newcomers initiate meaningful friendship connections?

Sign Up



Onboarding — Interests → Social Energy → Friendship Intent



Discover Vibe Matches (scrollable feed, filter chips, search)



View profile + Why You Might Vibe (all shared interests)



♥ Like (private signal)



Send Vibemate Request / Maybe Later(saves to Saved Vibes, no request sent)



Vibemate Request - or 📌 Save directly, or scroll past to skip



Accept / Decline



👉 Vibemates — both added to My Haus



💬 Chat (auto-unlocks) · ☕ Coffee Vibe · ⚡ Activity Vibe (each with its own accept/decline; either party can cancel a confirmed one)

This is the core loop the MVP must prove. **Events** (create/join/cancel/leave a public or private Vibe) is also part of the confirmed MVP, feeding into the same **Calendar** as Coffee/Activity Vibes. **Mr. Vibe** (a chip-based assistant for finding someone for a specific activity) was built during the sprint and is included as a **Stretch** feature — genuinely working, but not required to prove the core hypothesis. .

2. MVP Scope

Organized by Epic, matching the backlog in §4 exactly — story-level priority (Must/Should/Could/Won't) shown per item.

In Scope — MVP (Must, unless marked otherwise)

Epic A1 — Accounts & Authentication

- Create account (with email verification)
- Log in
- Log out
- Forgot password *Should: Recover password. Won't (MVP)/Future: Social sign-in.*

Epic A2 — Onboarding

- Select interests
- Select social energy
- Select friendship intent
- Add newcomer information

- Select connection preferences
- Complete onboarding

Epic A3 — Profile & Preferences

- Create personality-first profile (incl. photo)
- View own profile
- Edit profile
- Edit matching preferences
- Manage languages/newcomer details *Should: Delete Account (Settings). Could: Theme/Appearance (placeholder), Subscription (placeholder).*

Epic B1 — Vibe Match Discovery

- View recommended Vibe Matches (scrollable feed)
- Filter by Vibe band
- Search Discover
- Like a Vibe Match
- Save a Vibe Match
- Skip by scrolling past
- Open full profile *Should: Handle limited recommendations.*

Epic B2 — Explained Matching

- View Vibe Strength
- View Why You Might Vibe (all shared interests) *Should: Receive newcomer-aware explanation, receive shared-language explanation.*

Epic C1 — Vibemate Requests

- Prompt after Like
- Choose Maybe Later (saves to Saved Vibes)
- Send Vibemate Request
- View incoming/outgoing request
- Accept
- Decline
- Cancel a sent request
- Prevent duplicate requests

Epic C2 — My Haus

- Become Vibemates after acceptance
- Auto-add to My Haus
- View Vibemates tab (requests)
- View "X Vibemates" full roster
- Open a Vibemate's full profile from roster

- View Chats tab
- Remove Vibemate

Epic D1 — Chat

- Unlock Chat
- Send/receive messages
- View conversations
- Photo + tappable name in header
- Delete Chat *Moved to Next: Receive AI Icebreaker (Should).*

Epic D2 — IRL Plans

- Send Coffee Vibe
- Accept/decline Coffee Vibe
- Suggest Activity Vibe
- Accept/decline Activity Vibe
- Cancel a confirmed one (either party)

Epic E1 — Events Discovery

- Browse public Vibes
- View Vibe details
- View joined/hosted Vibes

Epic E2 — Create a Vibe

- Create event (activity, date/time, venue, description)
- Choose Public/Private
- Choose Open-to-all/Permission-based
- Invite specific people (by name or roster)
- Cancel own Vibe

Epic E3 — Event Participation

- Join Open-to-all Vibe
- Request to join Permission-based Vibe
- Accept/decline join requests
- Accept/decline private invite
- Leave an event

Epic E5 — Calendar

- View Upcoming (Confirmed)
- View Pending
- See "Hosting" label

- Tap any name to view profile
- Accept/decline/cancel directly from Calendar

Epic F1 — Safety Controls

- Block user
- Report user
- Remove Vibemate
- Prevent blocked-user contact
- Remove blocked user from Discover
- Live-check relationship status (never cached)
- View Community Guidelines

Epic Q1 — Product Quality & Core UX

- Handle loading/empty/error states
- Preserve optional profile fields
- Support end-to-end seeded demo flow
- Maintain consistent VibeHaus terminology

Stretch — built, not required for the core hypothesis

Epic M1 — Mr. Vibe (*Should*)

- Open Mr. Vibe (draggable, minimizes to edge tab)
- One-time coachmark
- Chip-based activity question (full interest list, no free text)
- Chip-based energy question
- View matched profiles with reason
- "Show more"
- Honest, consent-based no-match fallback
- Open matched profile, return to same conversation
- Scripted response to off-topic/distress input *Could: Static FAQ ("?" icon).*

Out of Scope for MVP (Next / Later / Future — see §4 for full detail)

- Voice/video calls, notifications, adaptive recommendations, language-aware matching
- Live map integration, real identity verification, moderation
- A fully free-text/live-generative Mr. Vibe
- High Five, group Vibes/events
- Newcomer cohorts, Local Buddy, neighbourhood matching
- Premium subscription/Hosted Experiences, city expansion, native apps

3. Monetization Model (Future — not MVP)

Don't charge people to make friends. Monetize enhanced discovery, convenience, and curated experiences.

- Core friendship features remain free and useful for free users.
- The built "Create a Vibe" feature (peer-to-peer, public/private meetups) stays free for everyone, always.
- VibeHaus Hosted Experiences (official, curated) — VibeHaus+ members get selected experiences included; free users purchase individually. A separate, future tier, distinct from the free Events already built.

4. Product Backlog — Themes → Epics

MVP TIER — NOW

Epic A1 — Accounts & Authentication

- Create account (with email verification) — Must
- Log in — Must
- Log out — Must
- Forgot password — Must

Epic A2 — Onboarding

- Select interests — Must
- Select social energy — Must
- Select friendship intent — Must
- Add newcomer information — Must
- Select connection preferences — Must
- Complete onboarding — Must

Epic A3 — Profile & Preferences

- Create personality-first profile (incl. photo) — Must
- View own profile — Must
- Edit profile — Must
- Edit matching preferences — Must

- Manage languages / newcomer details — Must

Epic B1 — Vibe Match Discovery

- View recommended Vibe Matches (scrollable feed) — Must
- Filter by Vibe band — Must
- Search Discover — Must
- Like a Vibe Match — Must
- Save a Vibe Match — Must
- Skip by scrolling past — Must
- Open full profile — Must
- Handle limited recommendations — Could

Epic B2 — Explained Matching

- View Vibe Strength — Must
- View Why You Might Vibe (all shared interests) — Must
- Receive newcomer-aware explanation — Should
- Receive shared-language explanation — Should

Epic C1 — Vibemate Requests

- Prompt after Like — Must
- Choose Maybe Later (saves to Saved Vibes) — Must
- Send Vibemate Request — Must
- View incoming Vibemate Request — Must
- View outgoing Vibemate Request — Must
- Accept Vibemate Request — Must
- Decline Vibemate Request — Must
- Cancel a sent Vibemate Request — Must
- Prevent duplicate requests — Must

Epic C2 — My Haus

- Become Vibemates after acceptance — Must
- Auto-add Vibemate to My Haus — Must
- View Vibemates tab (requests) — Must
- View "X Vibemates" full roster — Must
- Open a Vibemate's full profile from roster — Must
- View Chats tab — Must
- Remove Vibemate — Must

Epic D1 — Chat

- Unlock Chat — Must
- Send/receive messages — Must

- View conversations — Must
- Photo + tappable name in header — Must
- Delete Chat — Must

Epic D2 — IRL Plans

- Send Coffee Vibe — Must
- Accept/decline Coffee Vibe — Must
- Suggest Activity Vibe — Must
- Accept/decline Activity Vibe — Must
- Cancel a confirmed Coffee/Activity Vibe (either party) — Must

Epic E1 — Events Discovery

- Browse public Vibes — Must
- View Vibe details — Must
- View joined/hosted Vibes — Must

Epic E2 — Create a Vibe

- Create event (activity, date/time, venue, description) — Must
- Choose Public or Private — Must
- Choose Open to all / Permission based — Must
- Invite specific people (by name or roster) — Must
- Cancel own Vibe — Must

Epic E3 — Event Participation

- Join Open-to-all Vibe — Must
- Request to join Permission-based Vibe — Must
- Accept/decline join requests — Must
- Accept/decline private invite — Must
- Leave an event — Must

Epic E5 — Calendar

- View Upcoming (Confirmed) — Must
- View Pending — Must
- See "Hosting" label — Must
- Tap any name to view profile — Must
- Accept/decline/cancel directly from Calendar — Must

Epic F1 — Safety Controls

- Block user — Must
- Report user — Must

- Remove Vibemate — Must
- Prevent blocked-user contact — Must
- Remove blocked user from Discover — Must
- Live-check relationship status (never cached) — Must
- View Community Guidelines — Must

Epic Q1 — Product Quality & Core UX

- Handle loading states — Must
- Handle empty states — Must
- Handle error states — Must
- Preserve optional profile fields — Must
- Support end-to-end seeded demo flow — Must
- Maintain consistent VibeHaus terminology — Must

Stretch (built and tested, not required to prove the hypothesis):

Epic M1 — Mr. Vibe

- Open Mr. Vibe (draggable, minimizes to edge tab) — Should
- One-time coachmark — Should
- Chip-based activity question (full interest list, no free text) — Should
- Chip-based energy question — Should
- View matched profiles with reason — Should
- "Show more" — Should
- Honest, consent-based no-match fallback — Should
- Open matched profile, return to same conversation — Should
- Static FAQ ("?" icon) — Could
- Scripted response to off-topic/distress input — Should

NEXT TIER

Epic B3 — Lightweight Social Signals

- Send High Five — Could
- Receive High Five — Could
- High Five back — Could
- View High Five sender — Could

Epic B4 — Adaptive Recommendations

- Learn from reactions — Could
- Learn from successful Vibemate connections — Could
- Rate match relevance — Could

- Reset recommendation preferences — Could
- Explain recommendation changes — Could

Epic B5 — Language-Aware Matching

- Add preferred conversation languages — Could
- Prioritize shared-language matches — Could
- Discover language exchange partners — Could
- Explain language compatibility in Vibe Match — Could

Epic D1 (continued) — AI Icebreaker

- Receive AI Icebreaker — Should

Epic D3 — Voice & Video

- Request Call Access — Should
- Accept / decline Call Access — Should
- Unlock calling — Should
- Start voice call — Should
- Start video call — Should
- Receive incoming call — Should
- End call — Should
- Revoke Call Access — Should

Epic F2 — Trust & Verification

- Verify account — Should
- Display verification — Should
- Trust signals — Should
- Manage verification — Should

Epic F3 — Moderation

- Review reports — Should
- Suspend violating users — Should
- Moderate content — Should
- Escalate serious incidents — Should (*Automated safety detection sits in Phase 3 — Later.*)

Epic G1 — Notifications

- Vibemate Request notification — Could
- Vibemate accepted notification — Could
- New chat message notification — Could
- High Five notification — Could

- Coffee Vibe notification — Could
- Activity Vibe notification — Could
- Event invitation — Could
- Manage notifications — Could

Epic M2 — Live-Conversational Mr. Vibe

- Accept free-text descriptions of an activity, safely — Could
- Parse intent via a constrained LLM with a scripted fallback — Could
- Retain the same honest no-match and off-topic/distress handling under free text — Could

Epic N1 — Live Map Integration

- Replace static map preview with an interactive map — Should
- Search and pin a real venue — Should
- Show venue location on the recipient's side too — Should

LATER TIER

Epic E4 — Group Vibes

- Create Group — Could
- Join Group — Could
- Create Group Vibe — Could
- Invite Group — Could
- Group chat — Could

Epic F3 (continued) — Automated Safety Detection

- Automated safety detection — Could

Epic G2 — Re-engagement

- New Vibe Match notification — Could
- Relevant Vibe nearby — Could
- Inactive conversation reminder — Could
- Personalized activity recommendation — Could

Epic H1 — Newcomer Mode

- Select "new in Berlin" cohort — Won't
- Discover people who arrived recently — Won't
- Join newcomer-only activities — Won't

- Receive newcomer onboarding recommendations — Won't

Epic H2 — Local Buddy

- Become Local Buddy — Won't
- Find Local Buddy — Won't
- Match newcomer with established resident — Won't
- Suggest buddy activity — Won't

Epic H3 — Neighbourhood Community

- Select neighbourhood — Won't
 - Discover neighbourhood Vibemates — Won't
 - Discover local Vibes — Won't
 - Create neighbourhood Vibe — Won't
-

FUTURE TIER

Epic P1 — VibeHaus+ Subscription

- Discover VibeHaus+ plan — Won't
- View VibeHaus+ benefits — Won't
- Upgrade to VibeHaus+ — Won't
- Start subscription — Won't
- Manage subscription — Won't
- Cancel subscription — Won't
- Access VibeHaus+ benefits — Won't
- Restore subscription access — Won't

Epic P2 — VibeHaus Hosted Experiences

- Discover Hosted Experiences — Won't
- View Hosted Experience — Won't
- Reserve place — Won't
- Access included experience as VibeHaus+ member — Won't
- Buy Hosted Experience ticket as free user — Won't
- Join waitlist — Won't
- View booking / ticket — Won't
- Cancel booking — Won't
- Rate Hosted Experience — Won't

Epic P3 — Payments & Billing

- Add payment method — Won't

- Pay for VibeHaus+ subscription — Won't
- Pay for Hosted Experience — Won't
- View payment confirmation — Won't
- View billing history — Won't
- Handle failed payment — Won't
- Update payment method — Won't
- Receive refund — Won't

Epic P4 — Premium Features

- Access enhanced discovery preferences — Won't
- Access premium recommendation controls — Won't
- View premium feature indicator — Won't
- Unlock premium feature after upgrade — Won't
- Handle premium feature access after cancellation — Won't

Epic P5 — Conversion & Growth

- View VibeHaus+ upgrade prompt — Won't
- View contextual premium offer — Won't
- Start VibeHaus+ trial — Won't
- Complete trial-to-paid conversion — Won't
- View Hosted Experience member benefit — Won't
- Return to free experience without upgrading — Won't

Epic P6 — Monetization Analytics

- Track free-to-paid conversion — Won't
- Track trial-to-paid conversion — Won't
- Track subscription activation — Won't
- Track subscription cancellation — Won't
- Track premium retention — Won't
- Track Hosted Experience ticket purchase — Won't
- Track Hosted Experience attendance — Won't
- Track Hosted Experience-to-Vibemate conversion — Won't
- Track monetization revenue — Won't
- Track monetization funnel — Won't

Epic J1 — Multi-City VibeHaus

- Select city — Won't
- Change city — Won't
- City-specific recommendations — Won't
- City-specific events — Won't
- Localized onboarding — Won't
- Launch additional city — Won't

Epic J2 — Native Mobile Experience

- iOS application — Won't
- Android application — Won't
- Push notifications — Won't
- Native location services — Won't
- Mobile deep links — Won't

Epic A1 (continued) — Social Sign-In

- Social sign-in — Won't (MVP) / Future
-

4b. Consolidated List — Themes → Epics → Story Titles

One complete list, organized by Theme (A–J, plus M and N) rather than by phase, for quick reference. Same epic and story-title names as used everywhere else in this document — nothing renamed.

THEME A — Join & Express Yourself

Epic A1 — Accounts & Authentication — MVP

- Create account
- Log in
- Log out
- Forgot password
- Recover password — Should
- Social sign-in — Future

Epic A2 — Onboarding — MVP

- Select interests
- Select social energy
- Select friendship intent
- Add newcomer information
- Select connection preferences
- Complete onboarding

Epic A3 — Profile & Preferences — MVP

- Create personality-first profile
- View own profile

- Edit profile
- Edit matching preferences
- Manage languages / newcomer details
- Manage profile photo

THEME B — Find Your People

Epic B1 — Vibe Match Discovery — MVP

- View recommended Vibe Matches
- Like a Vibe Match
- Save a Vibe Match
- Skip by scrolling past
- Open full profile
- Handle limited recommendations — Could

Epic B2 — Explained Matching — MVP

- View Vibe Strength
- View Why You Might Vibe (all shared interests)
- Receive newcomer-aware explanation
- Receive shared-language explanation

Epic B3 — Lightweight Social Signals — Next

- Send High Five
- Receive High Five
- High Five back
- View High Five sender

Epic B4 — Adaptive Recommendations — Next

- Learn from reactions
- Learn from successful Vibemate connections
- Rate match relevance
- Reset recommendation preferences
- Explain recommendation changes

Epic B5 — Language-Aware Matching — Next

- Add preferred conversation languages
- Prioritize shared-language matches
- Discover language exchange partners
- Explain language compatibility in Vibe Match

THEME C — Become Vibemates

Epic C1 — Vibemate Requests — MVP

- Prompt after Like
- Choose Maybe Later (saves to Saved Vibes)
- Send Vibemate Request
- View incoming Vibemate Request
- View outgoing Vibemate Request
- Accept Vibemate Request
- Decline Vibemate Request
- Cancel a sent Vibemate Request
- Prevent duplicate requests

Epic C2 — My Haus — MVP

- Become Vibemates after acceptance
- Automatically add Vibemate to My Haus
- View Vibemates tab (requests)
- View "X Vibemates" full roster
- Open a Vibemate's full profile from roster
- View Chats tab
- Remove Vibemate

THEME D — Communicate & Make Plans

Epic D1 — Chat — MVP

- Unlock Chat after becoming Vibemates
- Start conversation
- Send message
- Receive message
- View conversations
- Photo + tappable name in header
- Delete Chat
- Receive AI Icebreaker — Should

Epic D2 — IRL Plans — MVP

- Send Coffee Vibe
- Accept / decline Coffee Vibe
- Suggest Activity Vibe
- Accept / decline Activity Vibe
- Cancel a confirmed Coffee/Activity Vibe (either party)

Epic D3 — Voice & Video — Next

- Request Call Access

- Accept / decline Call Access
- Unlock calling
- Start voice call
- Start video call
- Receive incoming call
- End call
- Revoke Call Access

THEME E — Connect Through Events

Epic E1 — Events Discovery — MVP

- Browse public Vibes
- View Vibe details
- View joined/hosted Vibes

Epic E2 — Create a Vibe — MVP

- Create event (activity, date/time, venue, description)
- Choose Public or Private
- Choose Open to all / Permission based
- Invite specific people (by name or roster)
- Cancel own Vibe

Epic E3 — Event Participation — MVP

- Join Open-to-all Vibe
- Request to join Permission-based Vibe
- Accept / decline join requests
- Accept / decline private invite
- Leave an event

Epic E4 — Group Vibes — Later

- Create Group
- Join Group
- Create Group Vibe
- Invite Group
- Group chat

Epic E5 — Calendar — MVP

- View Upcoming (Confirmed)
- View Pending
- See "Hosting" label
- Tap any name to view profile

- Accept/decline/cancel directly from Calendar

THEME F — Safety, Trust & Control

Epic F1 — Safety Controls — MVP

- Block user
- Report user
- Remove Vibemate
- Prevent blocked-user contact
- Remove blocked user from Discover
- Live-check relationship status (never cached)
- View Community Guidelines

Epic F2 — Trust & Verification — Next

- Verify account
- Display verification
- Trust signals
- Manage verification

Epic F3 — Moderation — Next / Later

- Review reports
- Suspend violating users
- Moderate content
- Escalate serious incidents
- Automated safety detection — Later

THEME G — Retention & Communication

Epic G1 — Notifications — Next

- Vibemate Request notification
- Vibemate accepted notification
- New chat message notification
- High Five notification
- Coffee Vibe notification
- Activity Vibe notification
- Event invitation
- Manage notifications

Epic G2 — Re-engagement — Later

- New Vibe Match notification
- Relevant Vibe nearby

- Inactive conversation reminder
- Personalized activity recommendation

THEME H — Newcomer & Community Experience

Epic H1 — Newcomer Mode — Later

- Select "new in Berlin" cohort
- Discover people who arrived recently
- Join newcomer-only activities
- Receive newcomer onboarding recommendations

Epic H2 — Local Buddy — Later

- Become Local Buddy
- Find Local Buddy
- Match newcomer with established resident
- Suggest buddy activity

Epic H3 — Neighbourhood Community — Later

- Select neighbourhood
- Discover neighbourhood Vibemates
- Discover local Vibes
- Create neighbourhood Vibe

THEME I — Monetization & VibeHaus+ *Post-scale / evidence-gated. Core friendship, communication, and safety functionality remains free.*

Epic P1 — VibeHaus+ Subscription — Future

- Discover VibeHaus+ plan
- View VibeHaus+ benefits
- Upgrade to VibeHaus+
- Start subscription
- Manage subscription
- Cancel subscription
- Access VibeHaus+ benefits
- Restore subscription access

Epic P2 — VibeHaus Hosted Experiences — Future

- Discover Hosted Experiences
- View Hosted Experience
- Reserve place
- Access included experience as VibeHaus+ member

- Buy Hosted Experience ticket as free user
- Join waitlist
- View booking / ticket
- Cancel booking
- Rate Hosted Experience

Epic P3 — Payments & Billing — Future

- Add payment method
- Pay for VibeHaus+ subscription
- Pay for Hosted Experience
- View payment confirmation
- View billing history
- Handle failed payment
- Update payment method
- Receive refund

Epic P4 — Premium Features — Future

- Access enhanced discovery preferences
- Access premium recommendation controls
- View premium feature indicator
- Unlock premium feature after upgrade
- Handle premium feature access after cancellation

Epic P5 — Conversion & Growth — Future

- View VibeHaus+ upgrade prompt
- View contextual premium offer
- Start VibeHaus+ trial
- Complete trial-to-paid conversion
- View Hosted Experience member benefit
- Return to free experience without upgrading

Epic P6 — Monetization Analytics — Future

- Track free-to-paid conversion
- Track trial-to-paid conversion
- Track subscription activation
- Track subscription cancellation
- Track premium retention
- Track Hosted Experience ticket purchase
- Track Hosted Experience attendance
- Track Hosted Experience-to-Vibemate conversion
- Track monetization revenue
- Track monetization funnel

THEME J — Expansion

Epic J1 — Multi-City VibeHaus — Future

- Select city
- Change city
- City-specific recommendations
- City-specific events
- Localized onboarding
- Launch additional city

Epic J2 — Native Mobile Experience — Future

- iOS application
- Android application
- Push notifications
- Native location services
- Mobile deep links

THEME M — Mr. Vibe

Epic M1 — Mr. Vibe — Stretch

- Open Mr. Vibe (draggable, minimizes to edge tab)
- One-time coachmark
- Chip-based activity question (full interest list, no free text)
- Chip-based energy question
- View matched profiles with reason
- "Show more"
- Honest, consent-based no-match fallback
- Open matched profile, return to same conversation
- Static FAQ ("?" icon) — Could
- Scripted response to off-topic/distress input

Epic M2 — Live-Conversational Mr. Vibe — Next

- Accept free-text descriptions of an activity, safely
- Parse intent via a constrained LLM with a scripted fallback
- Retain the same honest no-match and off-topic/distress handling under free text

THEME N — Discovery Infrastructure

Epic N1 — Live Map Integration — Next

- Replace static map preview with an interactive map
- Search and pin a real venue

- Show venue location on the recipient's side too

Cross-cutting (all phases) — Product Quality & Core UX

Epic Q1 — Product Quality & Core UX — MVP

- Handle loading states
 - Handle empty states
 - Handle error states
 - Preserve optional profile fields
 - Support end-to-end seeded demo flow
 - Maintain consistent VibeHaus terminology
-

5. MoSCoW Prioritization

Full detail lives in §4 against each epic; this section summarizes by priority level across all themes.

● **MUST HAVE — MVP** These prove the core VibeHaus hypothesis.

Epic A1

- Create account
- Log in
- Log out
- Forgot password

Epic A2

- Select interests
- Select social energy
- Select friendship intent
- Complete onboarding

Epic A3

- Create personality-first profile
- View own profile
- Edit profile
- Edit matching preferences
- Manage languages/newcomer details

Epic B1

- View recommended Vibe Matches
- Filter
- Search
- Like
- Save
- Skip by scrolling
- Open full profile

Epic B2

- View Vibe Strength
- View Why You Might Vibe (all shared interests)

Epic C1

- Prompt after Like
- Choose Maybe Later
- Send request
- View incoming/outgoing request
- Accept
- Decline
- Cancel a sent request
- Prevent duplicates

Epic C2

- Become Vibemates
- Auto-add to My Haus
- Vibemates tab
- Full roster
- Chats tab
- Remove Vibemate

Epic D1

- Unlock Chat

- Send/receive messages
- View conversations
- Photo + tappable name in header
- Delete Chat

Epic D2

- Send/accept/decline Coffee Vibe
- Suggest/accept/decline Activity Vibe
- Cancel a confirmed one (either party)

Epic E1/E2/E3

- Browse Events
- Create public/private
- Open-to-all / Permission-based
- Invite
- Join
- Request to join
- Cancel
- Leave

Epic E5

- Upcoming (Confirmed)
- Pending
- Hosting label
- Tappable names
- Act directly from Calendar

Epic F1

- Block
- Report
- Remove Vibemate (live-checked)
- Community Guidelines

Rationale: together these demonstrate the complete recommendation → mutual intent → meaningful interaction hypothesis. Events and Calendar were originally stretch goals but were fully built, tested, and promoted to MVP during the sprint. (Epic Q1 — Product Quality & Core UX also remains Must in §4/roadmap, but is not a feature epic and is excluded from this MoSCoW view.)

● SHOULD HAVE

- Recover password (A1)

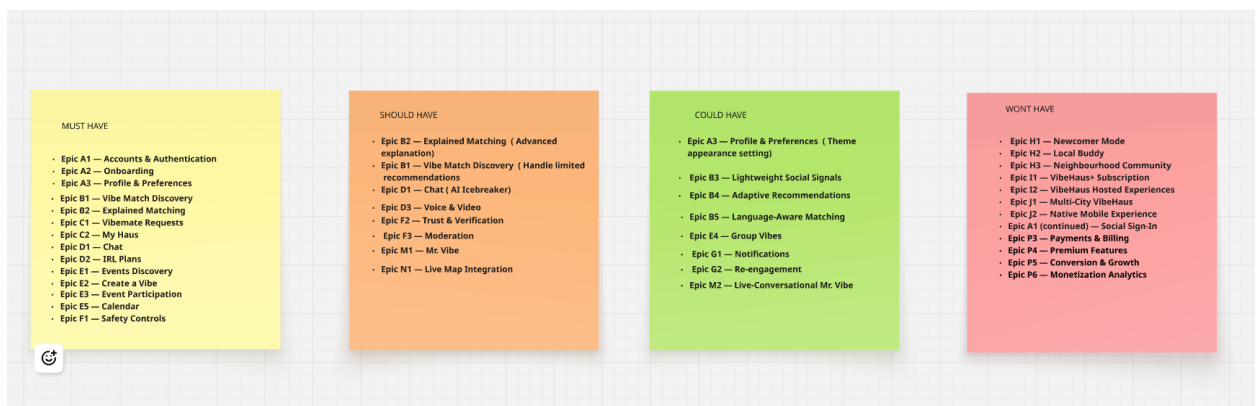
- Delete Account (A3)
- Newcomer/shared-language explanations (B2)
- AI Icebreaker (D1)
- Verify/display/trust/manage verification (F2)
- Review/suspend/moderate/escalate reports (F3)
- Voice & Video, all stories (D3)
- Mr. Vibe (M1) — the entire Stretch epic sits here: built and working, but not required to prove the core hypothesis.

● COULD HAVE

- Theme/Appearance, Subscription placeholders (A3)
- Handle limited recommendations (B1)
- High Five, all stories (B3)
- Adaptive Recommendations, all stories (B4)
- Language-Aware Matching, all stories (B5)
- Group Vibes, all stories (E4)
- Automated safety detection (F3)
- Notifications, all stories (G1)
- Re-engagement, all stories (G2)
- Mr. Vibe's static FAQ icon; Live-Conversational Mr. Vibe (M2), all stories
- Social sign-in (A1)

○ WON'T HAVE

- Newcomer Mode, Local Buddy, Neighbourhood Community (H1/H2/H3, all stories)
- VibeHaus+, Hosted Experiences, Payments & Billing, Premium Features, Conversion & Growth, Monetization Analytics (P1-P6, all stories)
- Multi-City VibeHaus, Native Mobile Experience (J1/J2, all stories)



6. MVP User Stories & Acceptance Criteria

(Only Must-Have stories are written out below. Should/Could/Won't remain titles only, above. Mr. Vibe (M1) moved to Stretch — its stories are written out at the end of this section for completeness, since it was fully built and tested.)

A1 — Accounts

A1.1 Create Account As a new VibeHaus user, I want to create an account using my email and password, so that my profile, preferences and Vibemate relationships can persist. Acceptance criteria

- Valid email/password creates an account and sends a verification email.
- Successful signup begins onboarding once verified.
- Invalid email displays actionable validation.
- Duplicate email displays a clear error.
- Failed signup does not create a partial account.

A1.2 Log In As a returning user, I want to log into VibeHaus, so that I can return to my Vibe Matches, Vibemates and conversations. Acceptance criteria

- Valid credentials authenticate user.
- User lands on Discover.
- Invalid credentials display an understandable error.
- Failed authentication does not expose technical information.

A1.3 Forgot Password As a user who can't remember their password, I want a way to reset it from the Login screen, so that I'm not locked out of my account. Acceptance criteria

- A "Forgot password?" link is visible on Login.
- Tapping it starts a reset flow (e.g. a reset email).
- The rest of the Login screen remains usable while this is pending.

A2 — Onboarding

A2.1 Select Interests As a new user, I want to select interests that represent my vibe, so that VibeHaus can recommend people with relevant common interests. Acceptance criteria

- "What's Your Vibe?" displays selectable interests.
- Multiple interests may be selected.
- Selected state is visible.

- Interests can be deselected.
- Back navigation preserves selections.
- Required minimum is validated before continuing.

A2.2 Select Social Energy As a new user, I want to describe how I like to socialize, so that my recommendations suit my social style. Acceptance criteria

- Chill, Balanced and Bring the Energy are available.
- Each has a short explanation.
- One option can be selected.
- Selection can be changed.
- Selection is saved for matching, and reused verbatim by Mr. Vibe's energy question (if enabled).
- Continue without selection triggers validation.

A2.3 Select Friendship Intent As a new user, I want to specify what kind of friendships I'm looking for, so that VibeHaus recommends people with compatible intentions. Acceptance criteria

- Multiple intentions may be selected.
- Options include friendships, coffee buddies, activity partners, hobby buddies and meeting newcomers.
- User can change selections.
- Intent is stored for matching.
- Missing required selection prevents continuation.

A2.4 Complete Onboarding As a new user, I want onboarding to be quick and clear, so that I can start discovering people without unnecessary friction. Acceptance criteria

- Required information is saved.
- Optional information can be skipped.
- Successful completion lands on Discover.
- Previously entered information remains intact.
- Missing required information produces clear guidance.

A3 — Profile

A3.1 Create Personality-First Profile As a user, I want my profile to communicate my personality and interests, so that potential Vibemates can judge whether we might connect. Acceptance criteria

- Profile supports name, age, city, photo and short personality description.
- Interests and friendship intent display.
- Optional information can be skipped.
- Missing optional information creates no blank sections.

- No unnecessary protected/sensitive attributes are collected.

A3.2 Edit Profile and Matching Preferences As a user, I want to update my profile and preferences after onboarding, so that my information stays current. Acceptance criteria

- Profile fields (photo, bio, interests, languages, newcomer details) can be edited.
- Matching preferences (social energy, intent, connection preference) can be edited.
- Changes are saved and reflected immediately in how the user's own profile appears to others.

B1 — Vibe Match Discovery

B1.1 View Vibe Matches As a user, I want to receive recommended people in a scrollable feed, so that I can find potential friends without a forced one-at-a-time flow. Acceptance criteria

- Discover displays recommendations from seeded and real profiles, in a continuous scrollable feed.
- Recommendations use interests, social energy and friendship intent.
- Cards provide sufficient personality information.
- Blocked users never appear.
- If no strong match exists, best-available recommendations appear rather than an empty screen.
- Filter chips (All Vibes / Strong Vibe / Good Vibe / Potential Vibe / Saved Vibes) narrow the feed and stay visible while scrolling.
- A search bar filters by name, interest, or city within the currently selected chip.

B1.2 React to a Vibe Match As a user, I want to privately Like or Save a profile, or simply keep scrolling, so that I can express interest without any pressure to make a forced choice on every card. Acceptance criteria

- Tapping the heart opens a choice: Send Vibemate Request (sends it, heart fills) or Maybe Later (sends no request, saves the profile to Saved Vibes instead, bookmark fills).
- Closing the popup without choosing either option records nothing.
- Tapping the bookmark directly saves the profile to Saved Vibes the same way, without needing to go through the heart.
- Scrolling past a card without tapping anything is a skip; nothing is recorded.
- No reaction of any kind notifies or is visible to the other person.
- If the profile shown is already a confirmed Vibemate, the heart/bookmark icons are replaced with a single "Reach Out" button offering Chat/Coffee Vibe/Activity Vibe instead.

B1.3 Open Full Profile As a user, I want to open a Vibe Match's full profile, so that I can decide whether I'd genuinely like to connect. Acceptance criteria

- Card opens correct profile.
- Profile displays personality, interests, social energy and intent.
- Optional fields display only when available.
- Sparse profiles render correctly.
- Returning to Discover preserves previous scroll position and filter chip.

B2 — Explained Matching

B2.1 Understand Why We Might Vibe As a user, I want VibeHaus to explain why someone was recommended, so that I can make my own decision instead of blindly trusting AI.

Acceptance criteria

- Profile displays a band such as Strong Vibe / Good Vibe / Potential Vibe.
- The explanation lists every genuinely shared interest, not capped at a small number.
- Explanation is grounded in stated user data.
- No unexplained precise percentage is displayed.
- Protected attributes are not used.
- Insufficient data produces a neutral explanation rather than fabricated compatibility.

C1 — Vibemate Requests

C1.1 Prompt Vibemate Request After Like As a user who likes a Vibe Match, I want to decide whether to send a Vibemate Request, so that liking someone's personality does not automatically contact them. Acceptance criteria

- Like is recorded (as a heart tap) before the prompt appears.
- Prompt offers Send Vibemate Request and Maybe Later.
- Send Request creates a pending request; the sender's heart fills to show it, and it appears under their own outgoing Pending list.
- Maybe Later sends no request and instead saves the profile to Saved Vibes.
- Repeated tapping does not create duplicate requests.

C1.2 Accept or Decline Vibemate Request As a recipient, I want to accept or decline a Vibemate Request, so that becoming Vibemates always requires mutual consent. Acceptance criteria

- Recipient sees the requester's full profile in a "Pending" state: full bio/interests, but Accept/Decline in place of Chat/Coffee/Activity/Remove.
- Accept creates a Vibemate relationship and shows a "Say Hi!" prompt with Chat/Coffee Vibe/Activity Vibe options.
- Decline creates no relationship.
- Sender cannot chat before acceptance.
- The sender can view their own sent request's profile in a "Pending, awaiting their response" state, and cancel it.
- Duplicate acceptance cannot create duplicate Vibemates.

C2 — My Haus

C2.1 Add Vibemate to My Haus As a user, I want accepted Vibemates automatically added to My Haus, so that I can find my connections in one place. Acceptance criteria

- Accepted users appear in both users' Vibemates roster.
- Connection appears only once.
- Declined requests do not appear.
- Vibemate's full profile can be opened, showing Chat/Coffee/Activity/Remove.
- Chat is available.

C2.2 View Vibemates Tab and Roster As a user, I want to see my Vibemate requests and my full connections list, so that I can manage both without them being mixed together. Acceptance criteria

- The Vibemates tab shows only incoming and outgoing requests (Accept/Decline, or Awaiting-response/Cancel).
- A "[X] Vibemates →" link opens the full alphabetical roster of every Vibemate, including people never chatted with.
- Tapping a roster row opens that person's full profile, with a live check of the relationship (Vibemate / Pending / not-connected, in case it changed since the list loaded).
- A "Remove" option is available directly on each roster row (with a confirmation warning) as well as from the full profile.
- Removed/blocked users do not appear in the roster.
- Empty roster displays helpful guidance.

C2.3 View Chats Tab As a user, I want a separate, searchable list of my actual conversations, so that I can find and continue chatting without scrolling through my whole connections list. Acceptance criteria

- Chats tab lists active conversations, sorted by most recent activity, with a live status preview.
- A working search finds any Vibemate by name, whether or not a conversation has started yet.
- An empty state reads "No Chats yet. Once you and a Vibemate connect, your conversation opens up here," with a hint to use search.

D1 — Chat

D1.1 Unlock Chat As a Vibemate, I want Chat to become available after mutual acceptance, so that we can safely get to know each other. Acceptance criteria

- Chat unlocks only for Vibemates.
- Non-Vibemates cannot initiate chat.
- Correct conversation opens.

- New chat displays an appropriate empty state.

D1.2 Send & Receive Messages As a Vibemate, I want to exchange messages, so that we can build rapport and make plans. Acceptance criteria

- Text messages can be sent.
- Messages display chronologically.
- Empty messages cannot be sent.
- Failed messages display retry/failure feedback.
- Unrelated users cannot access conversation.

D1.3 Chat Header — Photo and Profile Access As a Vibemate in a conversation, I want to see who I'm talking to and reach their full profile, so that I don't lose context mid-chat. Acceptance criteria

- The chat header shows the Vibemate's photo and name.
- Tapping the name or photo opens their full profile (Vibemate state: Chat/Coffee/Activity/Remove/Block/Report).
- Returning from that profile lands back in the same chat.

D1.4 Delete Chat As a user, I want to clear a conversation's history without ending the Vibemate relationship, so that I can tidy up without losing the connection. Acceptance criteria

- "Delete Chat" is available from the Chats tab.
- Deleting clears message history only.
- The Vibemate relationship, and the ability to message again, remains intact.
- This is visibly distinct from "Remove Vibemate."

D2 — IRL Plans

D2.1 Send Coffee Vibe As a Vibemate, I want to suggest meeting for coffee, so that we can move from online conversation to a casual real-world meeting. Acceptance criteria

- Coffee Vibe is available only between Vibemates, from the chat window.
- Required: date/time. Optional: a venue field with a static map preview, and a note (which can include a pasted link).
- The "what are you suggesting" field defaults to "Coffee" but accepts alternatives (e.g. tea, brunch).
- Recipient can Accept or Decline.
- Once confirmed, either party can cancel it, from the chat or from Calendar.
- Duplicate pending Coffee Vibes are prevented.

D2.2 Suggest Activity Vibe As a Vibemate, I want to suggest doing an activity together, so that we can connect through something we both enjoy. Acceptance criteria

- Activity Vibe is available only to Vibemates, from the chat window.

- Required: activity name, date/time. Optional: venue with static map preview, note.
- Recipient can Accept or Decline.
- Once confirmed, either party can cancel it, from the chat or from Calendar.
- Failed send provides feedback.
- Non-Vibemates cannot send Activity Vibes.

E1/E2/E3 — Events

E2.1 Create a Vibe As a user, I want to create a public or private event, so that I can organize something and invite the right people. Acceptance criteria

- Required: activity name, date/time. Optional: venue (static map preview + text field), description.
- A Public/Private toggle is required.
- Public events additionally require choosing "Open to all" or "Permission based."
- Public events can also invite specific people by name (search shows name + city to disambiguate).
- Private events can only invite from the host's own Vibemates roster; an empty roster shows an honest empty state, never fabricated names.

E3.1 Join or Request to Join As a user browsing Events, I want to join instantly or request to join depending on the event's mode, so that hosts keep the control they set. Acceptance criteria

- "Open to all" events show "Join Vibe," joining immediately and updating the attendee count.
- "Permission based" events show "Request to Join," creating a pending request.
- The host sees a "Manage requests" view listing pending requesters (tappable name → full profile, live relationship check) with Approve/Decline.
- Approving updates the attendee count and moves the event into the requester's confirmed list.

E3.2 Accept or Decline a Private Invite As an invited Vibemate, I want to accept or decline a private event invite, so that I only see and attend events I actually want to. Acceptance criteria

- An invited private event appears in the invitee's own Events list (Private chip) with Accept/Decline.
- Declining removes it entirely from the invitee's view.
- Accepting adds it to their confirmed events and to Calendar.

E2.2 Cancel a Vibe (Host) As a host, I want to cancel my own event, so that I can back out if plans change. Acceptance criteria

- "Cancel Vibe" is available from the main Events list and from Calendar's hosted view.
- A confirmation dialog ("Yes, cancel" / "Keep it") is required before anything happens.

- Confirming removes the event everywhere: the main list, every attendee's and requester's Calendar, and clears any pending requests.

E3.3 Leave an Event (Attendee) As an attendee, I want to leave an event I've already joined, so that I'm not stuck if my plans change. Acceptance criteria

- "Leave Event" is available to any joined/accepted attendee (not the host), from the main Events list and Calendar.
- A confirmation dialog is shown before leaving.
- Leaving removes the event from that user's confirmed list, decreases the attendee count, and notifies the host.

E5.1 View Calendar As a user, I want one place that shows everything I've confirmed or am waiting on, so that I don't have to check multiple screens. Acceptance criteria

- "Upcoming (Confirmed)" merges accepted Coffee/Activity Vibes and Events (joined or hosted), sorted by date.
- "Pending" merges awaiting Coffee/Activity Vibe invites and Event requests/invites, sorted by date.
- Hosted events show a "Hosting" label.
- Every person's name (Coffee/Activity Vibe partner, event host, event requester) is tappable, opening their full profile with a live relationship check, and returns to the same Calendar view.
- Cancel Vibe (host) and Leave Event (attendee) are both available directly from Calendar, not only from the main Events list.

F1 — Safety

F1.1 Block User As a user, I want to block another person, so that they can no longer contact or appear to me. Acceptance criteria

- Block is available from the "..." menu on a Vibemate's full profile and the chat header only (not Settings, roster rows, or Chats rows).
- Confirmation is required.
- Blocked user cannot contact blocker.
- Existing Vibemate relationship is removed.
- Blocked user disappears from Discover.
- Already-blocked state does not create an error.

F1.2 Report User As a user, I want to report unsafe or inappropriate behaviour, so that concerns can be flagged to VibeHaus. Acceptance criteria

- Report is accessible from the same "..." menu as Block.
- Report can be submitted.
- Confirmation appears.

- Duplicate accidental submission is prevented.
- Failed submission provides feedback.

F1.3 Remove Vibemate As a user, I want to remove a Vibemate, so that I remain in control of who belongs in My Haus. Acceptance criteria

- Removal is available from the roster row or the full profile, and requires a confirmation warning that chat history and plans will be deleted.
- The removed user's chat is deactivated and any pending/confirmed Coffee/Activity Vibes with them are cancelled.
- The relationship status is live-checked everywhere that profile can be viewed (Calendar, Chats, Discover, anywhere) — a removed person's profile shows Like/Save, never stale Chat/Coffee/Activity/Remove options.
- If reconnected later (a fresh request, accepted), it starts as a brand-new relationship with no old history.
- Already-removed state does not break the app.

F1.4 Community Guidelines As a user, I want clear community expectations, so that I understand how VibeHaus supports respectful platonic connections. Acceptance criteria

- Guidelines are accessible.
- Platonic purpose is clearly stated.
- Respectful conduct is covered.
- Block/report tools are explained.
- User can return without losing app state.

Q1 — Product Quality & Core UX

Q1.1 Loading, Empty, and Error States As a user, I want the app to behave predictably when there's nothing to show or something goes wrong, so that it never feels broken. Acceptance criteria

- Loading states are shown during data fetches.
- Empty states (no Vibemates, no Chats, no Saved Vibes, no Events) show helpful guidance, not a blank screen.
- Error states explain what happened without exposing technical detail.
- The seeded demo flow completes end to end without dead ends.

Stretch — M1 Mr. Vibe (built, tested, not required for the core hypothesis)

M1.1 Open Mr. Vibe As a user on Discover, I want a quick way to ask for help finding someone for a specific activity, so that I'm not limited to browsing the general feed. Acceptance criteria

- A floating Mr. Vibe icon appears on Discover only, draggable to any position for the session.
- Tapping it opens a bottom sheet (~70–80% of screen height), Discover still visible above.
- A one-time coachmark introduces Mr. Vibe on first use.
- Minimizing docks it to a tab at the screen's own edge, never rendering outside the app frame.

M1.2 Guided Chip Conversation As a user, I want to describe what I'm looking for through simple taps, so that the request is always clear and reliably searched. Acceptance criteria

- The activity question shows chips covering the app's complete interest list (no free-text input).
- The energy question shows Chill / Balanced / Bring the Energy, matching onboarding's exact wording.
- A brief loading state ("Finding your vibes...") appears before results.
- Choosing "try again" re-asks the activity question in the same visible thread, without losing prior conversation history.

M1.3 Matched Profiles and Honest Fallback As a user, I want real, explained matches or an honest "nothing found" message, so that I never see people who don't actually fit what I asked for. Acceptance criteria

- Up to 3 matches show first (photo, name, age, band, shared interests, a one-line match reason grounded in the actual request); "Show more" reveals up to 6 total only if genuine matches exist beyond 3.
 - If nothing reasonably matches, Mr. Vibe asks consent before showing general suggestions, framed as suggestions, not a match.
 - Tapping a matched profile opens their full profile (live relationship check); returning lands back in the same Mr. Vibe conversation.
 - Off-topic, support, or account-action requests receive a scripted redirect; Mr. Vibe never performs real account actions.
 - Messages signalling loneliness/distress receive one brief, warm, scripted acknowledgment before redirecting to the activity flow — no open-ended emotional support.
-

7. Roadmap & Release Strategy

Phase 1 — MVP: Fit-First Vibemate Discovery

0–5 Weeks | Prototype → MVP → Internal Alpha

Goal:

Validate whether fit-first, explained recommendations combined with mutual consent help newcomers and locals in Berlin form genuine friendships, rather than simply browse profiles.

Build

- Epic A1 — Accounts & Authentication
- Epic A2 — Onboarding
- Epic A3 — Profile & Preferences
- Epic B1 — Vibe Match Discovery
- Epic B2 — Explained Matching
- Epic C1 — Vibemate Requests
- Epic C2 — My Haus
- Epic D1 — Chat
- Epic D2 — IRL Plans
- Epic E1 — Events Discovery
- Epic E2 — Create a Vibe
- Epic E3 — Event Participation
- Epic E5 — Calendar
- Epic F1 — Safety Controls
- Epic Q1 — Product Quality & Core UX
- **Stretch:** Epic M1 — Mr. Vibe

Launch & Validation

- Prototype → MVP → Internal Alpha
- Small, controlled test group with seeded profiles where necessary.

Validation focus:

Can a user move from onboarding → Vibe Match → Vibemate Request → mutual acceptance → Chat → real-world coffee/activity plan, end to end? Does VibeHaus feel meaningfully different from swipe-first friendship apps?

Phase 2 — Validate: Trust, Retention & Reach

Months 2–3 | Internal Alpha → Closed Berlin Beta

Goal:

Prove match relevance, safety and repeat usage once real users—not just seeded profiles—become active on VibeHaus.

Build

- Epic D1 — Chat (AI Icebreaker story)
- Epic D3 — Voice & Video
- Epic F2 — Trust & Verification
- Epic F3 — Moderation
- Epic G1 — Notifications
- Epic N1 — Live Map Integration
- Epic M2 — Live-Conversational Mr. Vibe
- Epic B3 — Lightweight Social Signals
- Epic B4 — Adaptive Recommendations
- Epic B5 — Language-Aware Matching

Launch

- **Closed Berlin Beta:** ~50–100 invited users across overlapping Berlin communities.

Validation focus:

Do Vibe Matches and Vibemate Requests convert into meaningful conversations and real-world meet-up intent at a healthy rate? Do safety, trust and moderation controls hold up with real users?

Phase 3 — Scale: Berlin Network & Community

Months 4–9+ | Soft Launch Waves → Berlin Public Launch → Community

Goal:

Build sufficient network density across Berlin through gradual rollout while maintaining match quality, safety and meaningful connection rates.

Build

- Epic E4 — Group Vibes
- Epic G2 — Re-engagement

Launch

- **Wave 1:** ~10% of planned Berlin launch acquisition
- **Wave 2:** ~25%
- **Wave 3:** ~50%
- **Wave 4:** 100% → Berlin Public Launch
- Each expansion is gated by a Go/No-Go review.

Validation focus:

Does VibeHaus maintain sufficient Vibe Match availability, connection quality, retention and safety as the network grows without diluting the experience through overly rapid acquisition?

Note: Rollout percentages represent planned acquisition exposure, not a percentage of Berlin's population.

Phase 4 — Monetize: VibeHaus+

Post-Scale Validation | Pilot → Monetization Rollout

Goal:

Validate sustainable revenue models without putting essential friendship, communication or safety features behind a paywall.

Build

- **Epic P1 — VibeHaus+ Subscription**
- **Epic P2 — VibeHaus Hosted Experiences**
- **Epic P3 — Payments & Billing**
- **Epic P4 — Premium Features**
- **Epic P5 — Conversion & Growth**
- **Epic P6 — Monetization Analytics**

Monetization Model

VibeHaus+ introduces optional premium benefits such as enhanced discovery, additional recommendation controls, convenience features and access to selected VibeHaus Hosted Experiences.

VibeHaus Hosted Experiences are curated activities organized by VibeHaus—for example, newcomer coffee nights, international dinners, museum days, hiking experiences and small-group friendship events.

- **VibeHaus+ members:** selected Hosted Experiences included with membership.
- **Free users:** can purchase individual Hosted Experience tickets.
- **Core friendship features remain free:** Vibe Matches, Vibemate Requests, basic Chat and essential safety controls should not require a subscription.

Launch & Validation

- Pricing and willingness-to-pay research
- Premium concept testing

- Small VibeHaus+ pilot
- Limited Berlin monetization rollout
- Broader rollout only after positive validation

Validation focus:

Will users pay for enhanced discovery, convenience and curated experiences without reducing engagement with the free friendship experience?

Key metrics:

- Free → Paid Conversion
- Trial → Paid Conversion
- Monthly Recurring Revenue (MRR)
- ARPU
- Premium churn
- Hosted Experience ticket revenue
- Hosted Experience attendance
- Event → Vibemate conversion
- Premium retention
- LTV:CAC

Monetization principle:

Don't charge people to make friends. Monetize enhanced discovery, convenience and curated experiences.

Cross-Cutting Tracks

 **Responsible AI & Safety — All Phases:** Transparent and explained matching; banded Vibe Strength rather than unexplained compatibility percentages; no protected attributes used for matching; mutual-consent gating; Block/Report/Remove controls; and appropriate AI guardrails for recommendation features and Mr. Vibe.

 **Analytics & Learning — All Phases:** Measurement evolves with product maturity:

MVP: usability + core funnel completion

- Validate: match relevance + connections + safety + retention
 - Scale: network density + D7/D30 retention + community health
 - Monetize: conversion + revenue + ARPU + churn + LTV:CAC
-

Proposed Launch Progression

Prototype → MVP → Internal Alpha → Closed Berlin Beta (~50–100 users) → Wave 1 (~10%) → Wave 2 (~25%) → Wave 3 (~50%) → Wave 4 (100%) → Berlin Public Launch → VibeHaus+ Pilot → Monetization Rollout

Validation Gates

Progress to the next stage only when agreed thresholds are met for:

- Product reliability: Core flows work end to end.
 - User value: Recommendations lead to meaningful connections.
 - Network density: Users have enough relevant Vibe Matches.
 - Retention: Users have a reason to return after their first connection.
 - Safety: No unresolved critical safety issues; Block, Report and Remove operate reliably.
 - Monetization readiness: Revenue testing begins only after sufficient product value and retention have been demonstrated.
-

Future Opportunities — Explore After Core Roadmap Validation

1. Multi-City VibeHaus
Expand beyond Berlin once network density, retention and repeatable value have been demonstrated.
2. Newcomer Mode & Local Buddy
Help recent newcomers meet people at a similar stage or connect with established locals.
3. Neighbourhood Community
Enable more hyperlocal discovery and activities around specific Berlin neighbourhoods.
4. Native Mobile Experience
Develop dedicated iOS and Android experiences when usage and product requirements justify the investment.

One correction from the earlier version: I would remove “VibeHaus+ & Hosted Experiences” from Future Opportunities, because they’re now formally in Phase 4, and remove Group Vibes from the future section because Epic E4 is already committed to Phase 3. This prevents your PRD from showing the same capability in two different roadmap stages.

8. Launch Go/No-Go Criteria

Before expanding each rollout wave, evaluate four areas:

- Product — core connection flow completes reliably.
- User value — users find recommendations relevant and meaningful connections occur.
- Network — users have enough eligible Vibe Matches; Discover doesn't feel empty.
- Safety — no unresolved critical safety defects and Block/Report functionality works reliably.

If one area fails materially, hold the rollout rather than increasing acquisition.

9. AI Transparency

For the product: VibeHaus uses stated preferences and profile information to recommend potential Vibemates and explain why they may be compatible. Recommendations support user decisions rather than making them. Users retain control through Like/Save (or simply scrolling past to skip), Vibemate Requests, and mutual acceptance. Mr. Vibe (Stretch) extends this same rule-based matching to a specific, on-demand request, via a scripted, chip-based conversation rather than open-ended free text — a deliberate choice made after testing showed free-text intent parsing was unreliable.

For the capstone/backlog: Generative AI supported the initial organization and drafting of themes, epics, user stories, and acceptance criteria. The Product Manager reviewed, edited, and verified the backlog against discovery findings, user needs, product scope, safety considerations, and delivery feasibility. AI-generated requirements were treated as hypotheses rather than validated user needs.